

12 MARCH 2026

THIS IS THE MILITARY SEALIFT COMMAND NORFOLK, STRATEGIC SEALIFT PROGRAM SUPPORT OFFICE, N103A

SOURCES SOUGHT NOTICE NO.: N32205-SS-PM4-26-072

SUBJECT: TUGCON; OPEN-OCEAN TOW MISSION

1. THIS IS MARKET RESEARCH CONDUCTED BY THE PM4 PROGRAM OFFICE OF MSC. IT IS A REQUEST FOR INFORMATION ONLY, AND YOUR RESPONSE WILL NOT BE CONSIDERED AN OFFER. THIS REQUEST FOR INFORMATION DOES NOT COMMIT THE GOVERNMENT TO PAY ANY COSTS INCURRED IN THE PREPARATION OR SUBMISSION TO THIS MARKET SURVEY OR TO CONTRACT FOR SERVICES.

2. MSC REQUESTS INFORMATION ABOUT THE PRICE AND AVAILABILITY OF U.S. FLAG, JONES ACT, AND OCEAN-CERTIFIED TUGS CAPABLE OF TOWING A BARGE DERRICK CRANE (BDCM 6804) "IAW THE U.S. NAVY TOW MANUAL (SL740-AA-MAN-10)". THE REQUIREMENT IS FOR ONE VOYAGE.

3. DESCRIPTION OF THE TOW:

- 115 TON
- 200 FT - LENGTH OVERALL
- 80 FT - BEAM OVERALL
- 7 FT - DRAFT LIGHT
- 14 FT 4 IN - DEPTH

4. PORT(S)/PLACE(S) OF DEPARTURE: NORFOLK NAVAL SHIPYARD, PORTSMOUTH, VA

5. LAYTIME: FOUR (4) DAYS FOR THE ENTIRE MISSION.

6. PORT(S)/PLACE(S) OF DESTINATION: PEARL HARBOR NAVAL SHIPYARD, PEARL HARBOR, HI

7. LAYDAYS: COMMENCING/CANCELLING: 01 – 15 AUGUST 2026

8. TUG REQUIREMENTS:

- VESSEL/TUG SHALL BE BUILT IN 1970 OR LATER.
- BOLLARD PULL: SUFFICIENT TO TOW VESSEL IN SEASONAL WEATHER CONDITIONS AT A MINIMUM TOW SPEED OF 6 KNOTS. MAXIMUM TOW SPEED TO BE CALCULATED IAW THE U.S. NAVY TOWING MANUAL.
- TUG SHALL BE FULLY BUNKERED FOR THE VOYAGE.
- STOPS FOR FUEL OR SUPPLIES ARE AUTHORIZED.
- INTERNET AND SATELLITE PHONE CAPABILITY.
- CONTRACTOR SHALL OBTAIN THE SERVICES OF AN INDEPENDENT MARINE SURVEYOR (IMS). THIS SERVICE SHOULD BE INCLUDED IN THE

OFFER'S LUMP-SUM PRICE. THE IMS IS AN INDEPENDENT THIRD PARTY TO ACT AS A MEDIATOR BETWEEN THE NAVY AND THE CONTRACTOR TO PROVIDE INDEPENDENT ANALYSIS OF THE OPERATIONS AND TO ASSIST IN SETTLING DISAGREEMENTS. THE IMS SELECTED SHOULD BE PROPOSED BY THE TOWING CONTRACTOR AND AGREED TO BY THE MSC TECHNICAL REPRESENTATIVE. IMS DUTIES SHALL INCLUDE THE FOLLOWING, BUT ARE NOT LIMITED TO:

- PERFORM DETAILED TECHNICAL EVALUATION AND OVERSIGHT AS NECESSARY, TO ENSURE THE TUG AND CRANE BARGE ARE PREPARED AND RIGGED FOR TOW IAW THE U.S. NAVY TOWING MANUAL, AS APPLICABLE.
 - TECHNICAL EVALUATIONS SHALL INCLUDE A REVIEW OF THE FOLLOWING, BUT NOT LIMITED TO:
 - CONTRACTOR PREPARED TOW PACKAGE.
 - PRE-TOW CHECKLIST TO INCLUDE ITEMS SUCH AS VERIFYING THE CONDITION OF THE CRANE BARGE AS BEING SEAWORTHY OF THE TOW.
 - MATERIAL CONDITION OF THE TUG AND CRANE BARGE.
 - PREPARATIONS OF THE TUG AND CRANE BARGE.
 - INSPECTION OF ALL MATERIAL, EQUIPMENT, HARDWARE, LINES, AND REQUIRED CERTIFICATES.
 - COMPLETED U.S. NAVY TOWING MANUAL APPENDIX H.
 - ISSUE A TOWING CERTIFICATE WHEN THE TUG AND CRANE BARGE ARE SAFELY RIGGED FOR TOW.
- CONTRACTOR MUST PROVIDE TOW BRIDLE AND HARDWARE, EMERGENCY TOW LINES, FLOODING ALARMS, NAVIGATION LIGHTS AND DAY SHAPES IAW THE COLREGS RULES OF THE ROAD.
- CONTRACTOR MUST PERFORM NONDESTRUCTIVE TESTING (NDT) OF TOW VESSEL DECK FITTINGS FOR SUBMISSION IN A COMPREHENSIVE TOWING PACKAGE.
- U.S. NAVY TOWING MANUAL (SL740-AA-MAN-10) WILL BE USED AND COMPLIED WITH FOR THIS REQUIREMENT. THE LINK FOR DOWNLOAD IS: [HTTP://WWW.NAVSEA.NAVY.MIL/HOME/SUPSALV/00C2-SALVAGE-PUBLICATIONS/](http://www.navsea.navy.mil/home/supsalv/00C2-SALVAGE-PUBLICATIONS/).
- CONTRACTOR MUST PREPARE AND SUBMIT A COMPREHENSIVE TOWING PACKAGE FOR REVIEW AND APPROVAL PRIOR TO COMMENCEMENT OF TOW. THIS PACKAGE INCLUDES, BUT IS NOT LIMITED TO:
 - A COMPLETED APPENDIX H FROM THE U.S. NAVY TOWING MANUAL WITH ASSOCIATED DETAIL
 - STEADY STATE TOW LINE TENSION CALCULATIONS OVER THE SPECTRUM OF ANTICIPATED WEATHER CONDITIONS ALONG THE TOW ROUTE
 - SPEEDS OF ADVANCE (SOA)
 - WEATHER CONDITIONS AND LIMITS
 - A SKETCH OF THE TOW CONFIGURATION WHICH IDENTIFIES ALL COMPONENTS IN THE TOW RIG FROM THE TOW MACHINE ON THE TUG TO THE PAD EYES ON TOW (THIS INCLUDES TOW WIRE,

CONNECTING SHACKLES, CHAIN INSPECTIONS, AND PAD EYE NDT (NON-DESTRUCTIVE TESTING) INSPECTION PAPERWORK.

- DOCUMENTATION OF PEDIGREE, TESTING, OR STAMPING FOR THE INDIVIDUAL JEWELRY COMPONENTS TO ASSIST IN IDENTIFYING THE WEAKEST LINK AND TO FACILITATE FORENSIC ANALYSIS IN THE EVENT OF A FAILURE, AND TRACKING OF FAILURE TRENDS.
- TUG SPECIFICATIONS TO INCLUDE HULL AND TOW MACHINERY CERTIFICATIONS, BOLLARD PULL, TOW WIRE CERTIFICATIONS, AND THE MASTER'S TOWING ENDORSEMENT.
- ROUTE PLANNING AND IDENTIFICATION OF PORTS OF REFUGE INCLUDING ASSOCIATED RESTRICTIONS FOR ENTRY AS STATED BY THE CAPTAIN OF THE PORT. PANAMA CANAL TRANSIT EXPECTED.
- THE COMPLETED TOW PACKAGE MUST BE SENT TO NAVSEA AND MSC REPRESENTATIVES FOR APPROVAL PRIOR TO TOW.
- CONTRACTOR IS RESPONSIBLE FOR COORDINATING ALL ONSITE VISITS REQUIRED FOR ABS REPRESENTATIVE TO WITNESS TESTING AND INSPECTIONS AS REQUIRED.
- THERE WILL BE A PRE-TOW CONFERENCE IN PORTSMOUTH, VA PRIOR TO COMMENCEMENT OF THE TOW. THE TIME AND LOCATION OF THIS MEETING WILL BE MUTUALLY AGREED UPON BY MSC AND CONTRACTOR BUT SHOULD OCCUR NOT LATER THAN 24 HOURS BEFORE TOW COMMENCEMENT. REQUIRED ATTENDEES INCLUDE THE TUG CAPTAIN/CONTRACTOR REPRESENTATIVE, MSC REPRESENTATIVE(S), SPONSOR REPRESENTATIVE AND THE INDEPENDENT MARINE SURVEYOR (IMS).
- AT LEAST ONE (1) TRAIL TUG SHALL BE USED IN RESTRICTED, INLAND AND CHANNEL WATERS, AND IN ANY OTHER CIRCUMSTANCES WHERE CLOSE QUARTERS SITUATIONS EXIST, TO CONTROL THE VESSEL IN TOW.
- CONTRACTOR SHALL INCLUDE A TRANSIT PLAN IN THE OFFER THAT WILL DETAIL THE TRANSIT FROM PORTSMOUTH, VA TO PEARL HARBOR, HI. DETAILS SHALL INCLUDE ROUTE PLANNING AND IDENTIFICATION OF PORTS OF REFUGE INCLUDING ASSOCIATED RESTRICTIONS FOR ENTRY AS STATED BY THE CAPTAIN OF THE PORT.
- VESSEL DELIVERY SHALL BE COORDINATED WITH PEARL HARBOR NAVAL SHIPYARD AND MUST OCCUR DURING DAYLIGHT HOURS, MONDAY – FRIDAY.
- LUMP SUM AMOUNT SHALL INCLUDE UP TO FOUR (4) DAYS OF LAYTIME
- POSITION REPORTS. POSITION REPORTS SHALL BE ISSUED BY ELECTRONIC MAIL: VESSEL SHALL PROVIDE POSITION/STATUS REPORT IN PORT TWICE DAILY AT 0000Z AND 1200Z AND AT-SEA FOUR TIMES DAILY AT 0000Z, 0600Z, 1200Z, AND 1800Z. ADDITIONALLY, POSITION/STATUS REPORTS SHALL BE SENT UPON DEPARTURE AND ARRIVAL, AND AT OTHER TIMES REQUESTED BY THE APPLICABLE MSC AREA COMMAND FOR FORCE PROTECTION REASONS. REPORTS SHALL BE SENT TO THE EMAIL ADDRESSES THAT WILL BE PROVIDED AFTER THE CONTRACT AWARD.
- PLEASE SEE ATTACHED TECHNICAL DOCUMENTS FOR MORE INFORMATION ON GENERAL ARRANGEMENT, VESSEL TOW FITTINGS, AND TOW CERTIFICATION.

9. INTERESTED PARTIES ARE REQUESTED TO PROVIDE THE FOLLOWING INFORMATION:

- A. NAME AND COMPLETE DESCRIPTION/CHARACTERISTICS OF THE TOW VESSEL INCLUDING CERTIFICATE OF INSPECTION (COI), CERTIFICATE OF DOCUMENTATION (COD) OR CLASSIFICATION SOCIETY EQUIVALENT, PHOTOS, AND ALL DELIVERABLES AS PER MSC PROFORMA TUGCON 2024 (REV.1 (12-24)).
- B. LUMP SUM (INCLUDE UP TO 4 DAYS AT DESTINATION SITE FOR CUSTOMS/DELIVERY) AND DEMURRAGE RATE.
- C. ITINERARY, NUMBER OF DAYS REQUIRED TO COMPLETE THE TOW MISSION.
- D. BUSINESS SIZE. IF OTHER THAN SMALL BUSINESS, PROVIDE A NARRATIVE OF SUB-CONTRACTING POSSIBILITIES ENVISIONED, IF ANY. IF NONE, PROVIDE AN EXPLANATION.
- E. CONFIRMATION OF ABILITY TO MEET LAYDAY
- F. ANY OTHER PERTINENT QUESTIONS OR COMMENTS INCLUDING 46 CFR, CHAPTER 1, SUBCHAPTER M - TOWING VESSELS.

10. THE FEDERAL ACQUISITION REGULATION 19.102 ESTABLISHES THE SMALL BUSINESS SIZE STANDARD FOR THIS TYPE OF WATER TRANSPORTATION SERVICE AS NAICS “483111” WITH A SMALL BUSINESS SIZE LIMITATION OF 1,050 EMPLOYEES. PLEASE INDICATE IF BUSINESS IS A SMALL BUSINESS CONCERN.

11. RESPONSES ARE REQUESTED, VIA EMAIL, PRIOR TO **1100 HOURS, EASTERN TIME, 23 MARCH 2026**. THE POINT OF CONTACT IS **MATTHEW PRICE, EMAIL MATTHEW.R.PRICE40.CIV@US.NAVY.MIL, OR TEL (564) 230-3782**.

SIGNED: CHRISTOPHER TOMLIN, CONTRACTING OFFICER, MSC, N103